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DJIA 46677.85 ▼ 739.42 1.56% NASDAQ 22311.98 ▼ 1.8% STOXX 600 598.86 ▼ 0.6% 10-YR. TREAS. (Reopening) yield 4.272% OIL \$95.73 ▲ \$8.48 GOLD \$5,115.80 ▼ \$51.60 EURO \$1.1514 YEN 159.35

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The private-credit** engine that powered massive growth on Wall Street is sputtering as investors try to pull money from big funds, forcing firms into unpalatable decisions and jeopardizing their future profits. **A1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** retreated in the face of Iran's defiance, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow shedding 1.5%, 1.8% and 1.6%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Analysts forecast** long-lasting upheaval in the oil market and higher prices as a result of war-related disruption to Gulf energy supplies. **A1, A7, B9**
- ◆ **A war-fueled surge** in the price of fertilizer boosted producers' stock prices while forcing tough choices on farmers ahead of the spring planting season. **B1**
- ◆ **Initial jobless claims** were slightly lower last week, signaling layoffs by employers remain modest. **A2**
- ◆ **ByteDance** is assembling computing power with high-end Nvidia chips outside China to fuel its ambition of becoming a global artificial-intelligence leader. **B1**
- ◆ **Tesla secured a license** to supply electricity to households and businesses in Britain, a boost for a company seeking to expand its energy business. **B2**
- ◆ **Honda expects** to book up to \$15.7 billion in expenses and losses related to the reassessment of its EV strategy and expects to swing to its first annual loss in decades. **B4**
- ◆ **Adobe said CEO Shantanu Narayan**, who led the software company's transformation over the past 18 years, will step down after it finds a new leader for the AI era. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **A U.S. refueling plane** crashed in western Iraq and rescue operations were under way, as the American military pressed its punishing air campaign against Iran. **A5**
- ◆ **Arab diplomats trying** to find a path out of the war say Tehran, emboldened by its ability to rattle the global economy, laid out stern preconditions for talks. **A1**
- ◆ **Israeli officials assess** that Iran's regime is unlikely to fall in the immediate future as its leaders remain in control and conditions aren't ripe for a popular uprising. **A5**
- ◆ **A man previously** convicted of attempting to support Islamic State carried out a shooting at Old Dominion University that left one dead and two injured before students subdued and killed him. **A3**
- ◆ **An armed man** died after ramming his vehicle into a synagogue outside Detroit while the synagogue's preschool was in session. **A3**
- ◆ **The Senate passed** a landmark housing package, moving Congress a step closer to enacting a ban on large investors buying single-family homes. **A3**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** sued California in an effort to shut down the state's initiative to limit carbon emissions from cars and transition to zero-emission vehicles. **A3**
- ◆ **Google said it used** artificial intelligence to pool data on historically difficult-to-predict flash floods in an effort to help communities prepare. **A2**
- ◆ **A sudden and unusual** interruption in frequent Chinese military flights near Taiwan stoked uncertainty about Beijing's intentions. **A9**

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A woman surveys damage Thursday to a Haniel, Israel, home hit by a rocket barrage fired from Lebanon by Iran's Hezbollah allies.

Oil Market Turmoil Expected To Linger as Price Tops \$100

Analysts are now forecasting longer-lasting upheaval—and higher prices

By REBECCA FENG

The oil market is waking up to a new reality: Disruption to the Gulf's energy supplies isn't ending anytime soon. When the U.S. and Israel first attacked Iran, some traders expected days of disorder. Now they are expecting the turmoil to last weeks or months. On Thursday, Brent

crude shot back above \$100 a barrel amid growing concerns about a protracted period of disruption to the oil market. Futures settled at \$100.46, up more than 9% for the day. Several tankers were attacked in the Strait of Hormuz on Thursday, with Iran's new supreme leader vowing to keep the vital waterway closed. President Trump said stopping the Iranian regime from getting nuclear weapons was a higher priority than oil prices. Several analysts said crude could hit new multiyear highs if the conflict drags on. *Please turn to page A7*

Brent crude-oil futures price



Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Air Force Refueling Plane Crashes In Iraq

Midair collision is suspected in loss of U.S. craft taking part in Iran campaign

A U.S. refueling plane crashed in western Iraq Thursday, as the American military pressed its punishing air campaign against Iran.

By Michael R. Gordon, Marcus Weisgerber and Shelby Holliday

Rescue operations were under way, and the U.S. military didn't say whether the servicemembers in the U.S. KC-135 Stratotanker were killed in the crash. Any fatalities would mark the first Air Force losses during the war with Iran, according to the military. Two aircraft were involved in what initial reports pointed to as a midair collision, said people familiar with the episode. The second aircraft, which is also a KC-135, landed safely, U.S. officials said. Central Command, which oversees U.S. forces in the Middle East, said the loss of the plane wasn't caused by hostile or friendly fire. Aerial refueling tankers play an essential, though often unheralded, role in an air campaign. *Please turn to page A5*

Iran Sets High Bar on Talks to End the Conflict

By SUMMER SAID AND BENOIT FAUCON

Arab diplomats trying to find a diplomatic path out of the war being waged by the U.S. and Israel against Iran said Tehran, emboldened by its abil-

ity to rattle the global economy by choking oil shipments, has laid out steep preconditions for any return to talks. Iran is demanding that the airstrikes stop before it entertains cease-fire discussions and wants firm guarantees it

won't be attacked again if it agrees to stop the fight, Arab diplomats said. It also wants reparations for damages and is hoping to get U.S. forces to disengage from the region. The demands are part of a broader public expression of

confidence in recent days. After nearly two weeks of intense U.S. and Israeli airstrikes that killed Iranian Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei, sunk much of the Iranian navy and hit its missile sites, Iran's leadership appears to

be firmly in control and capable of landing blows against its neighbors. Its military continues to score hits on targets around the region, including a number of tankers and cargo ships. *Please turn to page A5*

Iran's regime It still has a strong grip on power, Israelis say. A5	Military Diplomat-warrior leads U.S. force in Mideast. A8	Rising prices Airfares climb, driven largely by fuel costs. B1	Stocks tumble Economic risks of war hit stock indexes. B1	Heard on the Street Why investors aren't fleeing to haven stocks. B10
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INSIDE



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Tesla's grand plan for the future is a car with no steering wheel. **B1**



MANSION
Big-budget fish tanks are taking over America's most expensive homes. **M1**

Silicon Valley's New Obsession: Watching Bots Do Their Work

Fleets of AI assistants check emails, manage calendars while techies play

By KATE CLARK

At a holiday gathering in San Francisco, partygoers sipped Celsius and kept sneaking glances at their cracked-open laptops with a mix of pride and fear. They were checking on their fleets of AI assistants to make sure they were still laboring away. What are your bots up to? The topic is the biggest flex—and source of stress—in Silicon Valley, where tech pros and amateurs are competing to see how much of their grunt work they can outsource to AI with-

out things backfiring spectacularly. They're enlisting agents to code, manage their calendar and respond to emails. Bots' human masters set them to work when they go to sleep or to parties, and check on them regularly. Call them the modern day Tamagotchi, the digital pet from the 1990s, but with a lot more firepower. Nikunj Kothari, a venture capitalist by day who builds apps by night, wakes up and checks his agents first thing in the morning, before coffee. He says he barely watches Netflix anymore because playing with *Please turn to page A10*

Exodus of Money Endangers Finance's Private-Credit Craze

The private-credit engine that powered massive growth on Wall Street is sputtering, with investors trying to pull

By Matt Wirz, Peter Rudegeair and Gina Heeb

money out of big funds, forcing firms into uncomfortable decisions and endangering their future profits. The latest example came

Wednesday when Cliffwater Capital told clients that investors in its largest fund asked to cash out 14% of their money this quarter. The \$33 billion fund will pay out about 50% of the redemption requests, meaning that the other half will need to wait at least another quarter to exit. Cliffwater sold its funds primarily to individual investors, a playbook that larger competitors like Apollo Global

Management, BlackRock, Blackstone and Blue Owl adopted, making them all increasingly dependent on "retail" money for growth. They harbored hopes of getting an even bigger slice of individual's money, pushing to get access to 401(k)s. The strategy started backfiring unexpectedly in recent months. Some bad loans from both private-lenders and *Please turn to page A2*

TOMORROW



WSJ. MAGAZINE

COLMAN DOMINGO

An African Coup Unravels in 24 Hours

Scramble for power kicked off gunbattles, kidnapping and betrayal

By MICHAEL M. PHILLIPS

COTONOU, Benin—Perhaps Maj. Gen. Abou Issa should have realized he was facing a coup d'état when a junior soldier punched him in the mouth. The soldier belonged to an emergency unit dispatched to Issa's house to rescue him from a dark-of-night attack by masked gunmen. Instead of saving the general, half-a-dozen soldiers clubbed him into bloody unconsciousness with their rifle butts. But it had already been a

confusing night of strange and violent events. Someone broke down the door of Issa's house. Someone shot at his wife. Someone stole a 24-pack of Sprite from his larder. So even when the 60-year-old chief of staff of Benin's army came to in the back of an armored vehicle, he still wasn't sure why all this was happening to him. He was confident of one thing, though: "I thought I was going to die that day." This is the inside story of a coup d'état—of gunfights and *Please turn to page A10*